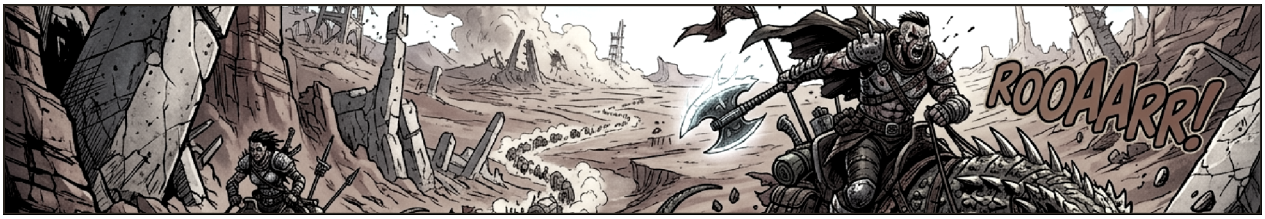
BLAST OR BUST

MODULE 1: CHARACTER CREATION AND ADVANCEMENT



FORGING YOUR ALTER EGO

Your survival in this unforgiving world depends entirely on how you forge your alter ego. You are not destined saviors or polished mercenaries; you are scavengers scraping a violent living under an incinerating sun. Follow these six steps to build your hero:

STEP-BY-STEP CHARACTER CREATION

1. **Archetype:** Select an Archetype from the available list, record it on your character sheet, and apply its unique feature upon creation.
2. **Level:** Establish starting Level with your Referee (typically Level 1).
3. **Focus:** Choose whether your character leans toward **Physical** or **Mental**. Underline your chosen primary Attribute category on your sheet.
4. **Attributes:** Assign die ratings:
   - **d8** to one Attribute within your primary category.
   - **d10** to a second Attribute of your choice.
   - **d12** to a third Attribute of your choice.
   - All remaining Attributes begin at Incompetence (**d20**).
5. **Equipment:** Select one Special Item from your Archetype's starting gear list and add it to your inventory.
6. **Resource Calculation:** Determine your Physical HP and Mental MP pools as shown on the right.

CHARACTER ADVANCEMENT

At the conclusion of each completed quest or narrative Book, surviving heroes advance in power:

- **Attribute Upgrade:** Choose one Attribute and step up its die size by one tier (e.g., **d10 → d8**).
- **Recalculate Pools:** Recalculate your maximum HP or MP using the upgraded Attribute point value.
- **Mastery Ceiling:** No Attribute rating may step past **d6**. Beyond this threshold lies the absolute limit of human capability... besides, rolling d4s lacks physical satisfaction.

RESOURCE POOLS (HP & MP)

Maximum Physical HP and Mental MP pools equal the sum of point values derived from your three Physical and Mental Attributes, respectively.

Die Size	Competence Level	Pool Point Value
d6	Mastery Ceiling	**12** points
d8	Trained Specialty	**11** points
d10	Competent	**9** points
d12	Novice	**6** points
d20	Incompetence	**2** points

CALCULATION EXAMPLE

A **Warrior** (Physical Focus) with Physical attributes **STR d10**, **COS d8**, and **AGI d20** has **22 HP** (9 + 11 + 2). With Mental attributes **PRE d12**, **WIT d20**, and **KNO d20**, they possess **10 MP** (6 + 2 + 2).

ARCHETYPE VARIATIONS & TRAITS

Each Archetype possesses a radical creation feature that bends the starting rule parameters:

• **Warrior** *(Gladiator, Martialist, Primordial)*: Sets **two** Attributes to **d8**, with the remainder at **d20**.

• **Scout** *(Tomb Raider, Assassin, Survivor, Spy, Saboteur)*: Assigns **d8, d10, and d12** completely freely across any Attributes regardless of primary Focus.

• **Arcanist** *(Heretic, Saurian Binder, Mechanist, Archaeologist)*: The **only class capable of activating Arcane Artifacts**; starts with **two** artifacts from their list.

• **Cleric** *(Zealot, Prophet, Healer, Bard, Performer)*: Starts with **four Attributes at d10** and the remaining two at **d20**.

• **Noble** *(Knight, Prelate, Merchant)*: Starts with **three items**—one class item and two items chosen from different Archetype lists (excluding Arcane Artifacts).

MASTERY TRACK D6 ← D8 ← D10 ← D12 ← D20

ARCHETYPE ARSENAL

Select your starting gear from your designated class list. In the White Ash Wastes, iron is scarce and relics are soaked in Old World blood.

Warrior Arsenal

Gladiator • Martialist • Primordial

• **Greatsword:** Grant **1 reroll on damage rolls** when calculating damage after overcoming an obstacle.

• **Tower Shield:** Sturdy defensive slab forged of scavenged armor plates. **Absorbs 1d8 incoming damage** from an obstacle's Counterattack.

• **Skull Helm:** A terrifying trophy carved from sauroid bone. Sets the difficulty threshold for any Intimidation or terror check to **Moderate (14+)**.

Scout Arsenal

Tomb Raider • Assassin • Survivor

• **Mantle:** Threadbare shroud woven from ash-dune reeds. In darkness, your difficulty threshold is capped at **Moderate (14+)**.

• **Venomous Sauroid Fang:** Coated in neurotoxin. On a successful attack with edged or piercing weapons, deal **+1d4 poison damage per round** until the Obstacle is overcome.

• **Rust-Eater Oil:** Caustic alchemical sludge. Sets difficulty threshold to **Moderate (14+)** against rusted locks, ancient machinery, or metallic plate armor.

Arcanist Relics (Arcane)

Heretic • Saurian Binder • Mechanist

***Arcane Restriction:** Only Arcanists possess the psychic attunement to activate Arcane Artifacts.*

• **Saurohide Gauntlets (Arcane):** Insulated leather tanned in gland fluid. Allows handling **white-hot, electrified, or corrosive objects** without taking damage or losing grip.

• **Centennial Toad-Saur Glass Eye (Arcane):** A crystallized ocular lens. Knowledge (KNO) checks involving machinery or biomechanical locks are capped at **Moderate (14+)**.

• **Tome of Forbidden Whispers (Arcane):** Suffer **1d4 MP** to instantly learn an Obstacle's current HP and secret vulnerabilities; sets difficulty threshold against it to **Moderate (14+)**.

Cleric Relics

Zealot • Prophet • Healer • Bard

• **Micro-Thalassic Culture:** Bioluminescent flask of regenerative primordial organisms. Once per session, **restore 1d4 HP or MP to all party members** (including self).

• **Sauroid Bone Candelabra:** Blessed relic radiating zeal. Once per session when lit, each party member deals **+1 bonus die of damage** for the entire scene's duration.

• **Divine Compass:** An erratic needle tuned to moral currents. Once per session, **reveals the optimal physical direction or moral choice** to secure the best narrative outcome.

Noble Regalia

Knight • Prelate • Merchant

• **Heir's Bangle:** Ancient heirloom forged of resonant alloy. **Glows brightly whenever lethal danger is imminent**, warning against ambushes or collapsing traps.

• **Signet of a Fallen House:** Heavy gold signet. Sets difficulty threshold for Mental checks against nobles, bureaucrats, courtiers, or guildmasters to **Moderate (14+)**.

• **Medal of Valor:** Tattered battle honor. Sets difficulty threshold for Mental checks against subjects of lower station or common mercenaries to **Moderate (14+)**.

Noble Cross-Class Starting Allowance

Nobles begin play with **three total items**: one starting item from the Noble list above, plus two additional items chosen freely from the Warrior, Scout, or Cleric lists (Arcane Artifacts remain forbidden).

Starting Equipment & Survival Gear

Record your chosen Archetype Special Item on your character sheet upon creation. In addition to their starting relic or weapon, every wanderer of the ash wastes carries basic survival kit: rugged travel garments or scavenged hides, a waterskin, two days of dried rations, and a simple utility knife or crow-chisel.

BLAST OR BUST • CHARACTER SHEET

CHARACTER NAME | PLAYER NAME | LEVEL

ARCHETYPE & TITLE / CONCEPT | QUEST / BOOK MILESTONE

PRIMARY FOCUS: (Underline chosen category below) ☐ PHYSICAL FOCUS ☐ MENTAL FOCUS

PHYSICAL HEALTH (HP)

MAX HP ☐ — STR + AGI + COS POINTS

CURRENT HP: _____

MENTAL COMPOSURE (MP)

MAX MP ☐ — WIT + KNO + PRE POINTS

CURRENT MP: _____

POINT VALUES & POOL FORMULA

Die	d20	d12	d10	d8	d6
Pts	2	6	9	11	12

Max Pool = sum of 3 corresponding attribute point values.

PHYSICAL ATTRIBUTES

Strength (STR)	☐	☐D20	☐D12	☐D10	☐D8	☐D6
Agility (AGI)	☐	☐D20	☐D12	☐D10	☐D8	☐D6
Constitution (COS)	☐	☐D20	☐D12	☐D10	☐D8	☐D6

MENTAL ATTRIBUTES

Wits (WIT)	☐	☐D20	☐D12	☐D10	☐D8	☐D6
Knowledge (KNO)	☐	☐D20	☐D12	☐D10	☐D8	☐D6
Presence (PRE)	☐	☐D20	☐D12	☐D10	☐D8	☐D6

EQUIPMENT & POSSESSIONS

Weapons, Relics & Gear

Starting Archetype Special Item: _____

CHARACTER PORTRAIT

Alter Ego Sketch

DRAW YOUR SURVIVOR

Wasteland Visage • Ceramic Mask • Scars • Scavenged Kit

ARCHETYPE FEATURE, POWERS & RELICS

Rules, Miracles & Traits

WASTELAND SCARS, VOWS & CAMPAIGN LOG:

Maimings, oaths sworn to dust-tribes, and milestones